Thursday: Strength & Conditioning (Peak Day)

Weeks 1-2: Oct 1, Oct 8 | RPE 8 | ~65 min

Warm-up

10 min

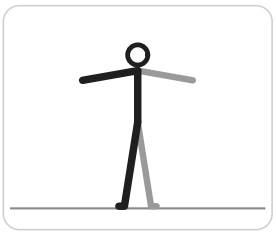
- 5 min easy rower or bike.

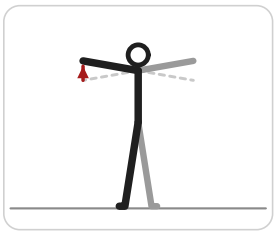
Arm circles

10 forward, 10 backward

Front view

1. Arms straight out at shoulder height.
2. Start with small circles, let them grow.
3. Reverse direction halfway.


Arms out

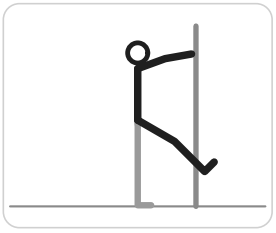

Circle

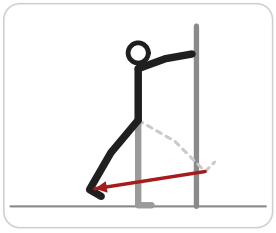
Leg swings

10 per leg

Side view

1. Hold a wall for balance.
2. Swing forward and back, loose and controlled.
3. Stay tall. Don't let your back round.


Swing forward

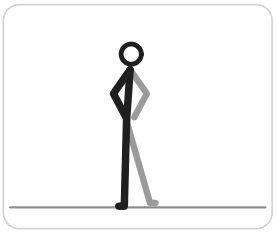

Swing back

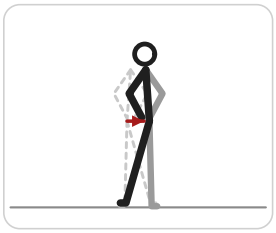
Hip circles

10 each direction

Front view

1. Hands on hips, feet shoulder-width apart.
2. Draw big, slow circles with your hips.
3. Keep your head and shoulders quiet.


Hips left

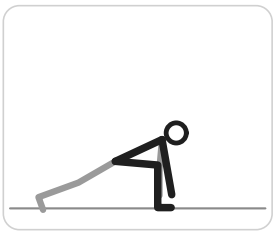

Hips right

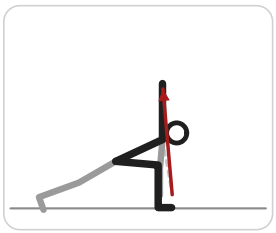
World's greatest stretch

3 per side

Side view

1. Step into a deep lunge, back knee off the floor.
2. Drop your inside elbow toward your front instep.
3. Rotate and reach that hand to the ceiling. Eyes follow the hand.


Elbow to instep

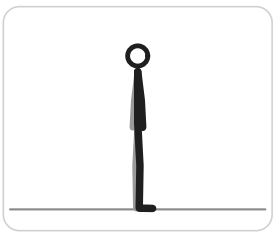

Rotate and reach

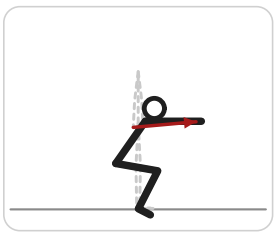
Bodyweight squat

10 reps

Side view

1. Feet shoulder-width, toes slightly out.
2. Sit back and down, chest up, arms forward.
3. Knees track over toes. Drive up through the whole foot.


Stand tall

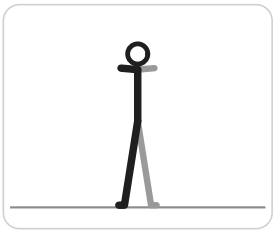

Bottom

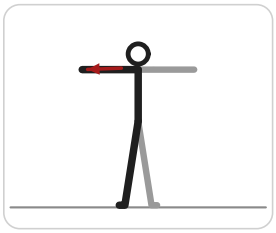
Band pull-apart

15 reps

Front view

1. Hold the band at chest height, arms straight in front.
2. Pull it apart until it touches your chest.
3. Squeeze your shoulder blades. Control the return.


Arms in front


Pull apart

- 1-2 light ramp-up sets before your first lift.

Power

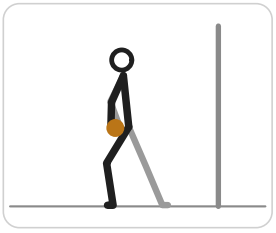
Do these while fresh

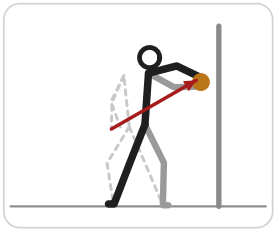
Med ball rotational throw

3 x 5 per side

Front view

1. Stand side-on to the wall, feet wider than shoulders.
2. Load the ball at your back hip, then turn hips first, arms last.
3. Throw hard into the wall and catch it on the rebound.


Load

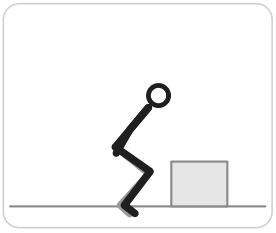

Throw

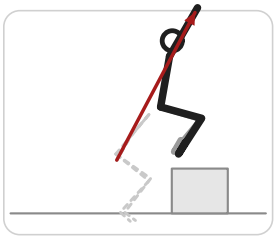
Box jump

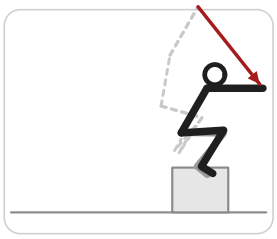
3 x 5

Side view

1. Quarter squat and swing your arms back.
2. Explode up, swing the arms, land soft on the box with bent knees.
3. Stand up tall, then STEP down. Don't jump down.
4. Beginner: squat jump onto a low box or no box.


Load


Jump


Land soft

Strength

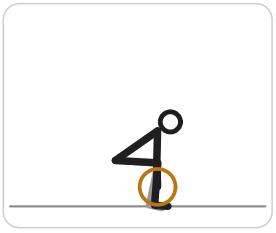
Pick weights where the last 2 reps are hard but form stays clean

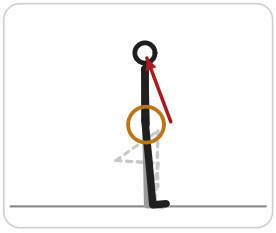
Trap bar deadlift

A. 3 x 8, 2 min rest

Side view

1. Stand in the middle of the bar, grip the handles, hips back, chest up.
2. Push the floor away. Hips and shoulders rise together.
3. Stand tall and squeeze. Lower by pushing the hips back first.
4. Beginner: kettlebell deadlift, 3 x 10.


Bottom

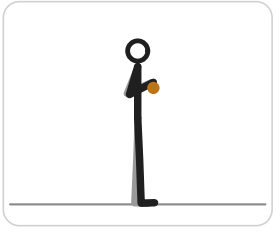

Lockout

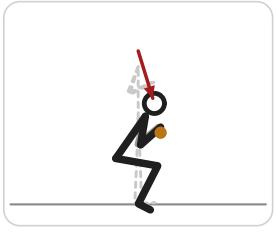
Goblet squat

B1. 3 x 10, alternate with B2

Side view

1. Hold a kettlebell or dumbbell at your chest, elbows down.
2. Sit down between your heels, chest tall.
3. Elbows inside the knees at the bottom. Drive up through the whole foot.


Stand

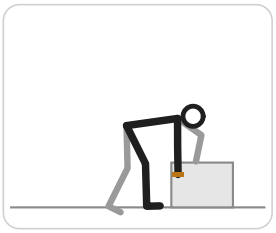

Bottom

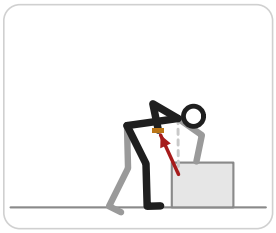
Single-arm dumbbell row

B2. 3 x 10 per side. 90 sec rest after each B pair.

Side view

1. Free hand on the bench, back flat, dumbbell hanging straight down.
2. Pull the dumbbell to your hip, elbow close to your body.
3. Lower with control. Don't twist your torso to lift it.


Arm long

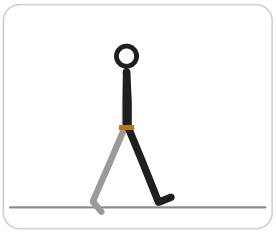

Row to hip

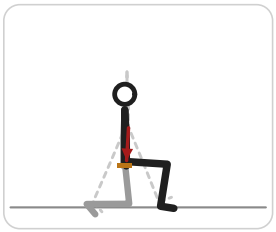
Dumbbell split squat

C1. 3 x 8 per side, alternate with C2

Side view

1. Long split stance, back heel up, dumbbells at your sides.
2. Drop the back knee straight down toward the floor.
3. Front knee stays over the ankle. Drive up through the front foot.


Top

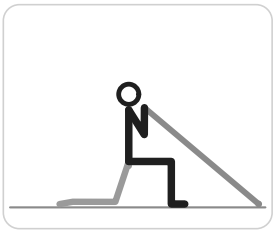

Bottom

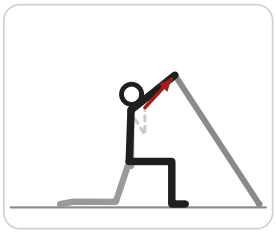
Half-kneeling landmine press

C2. 3 x 8 per side. 90 sec rest after each C pair.

Side view

1. Half-kneeling, bar end at your shoulder, back knee down on the same side as the pressing hand.
2. Press up and forward until your arm is straight.
3. Squeeze the glute of the down leg. Don't lean back.


Bar at shoulder


Press

Metabolic finisher

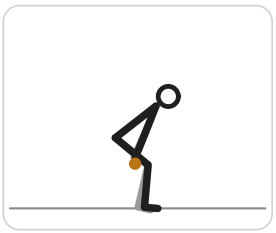
12 min EMOM: cycle the 3 stations 4 times. Beginner: 30 sec work, rest the rest of each minute.

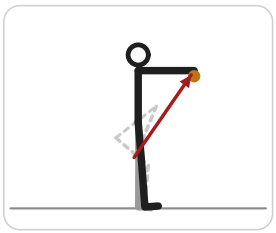
Kettlebell swing

Minute 1: 12 swings

Side view

1. Hike the bell back between your legs, hips back, flat back.
2. Snap the hips forward hard. The hips move the bell, not the arms.
3. Bell floats to chest height. Stand tall, squeeze the glutes, then hike again.


Hike back

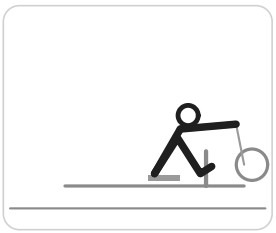

Hips snap, float

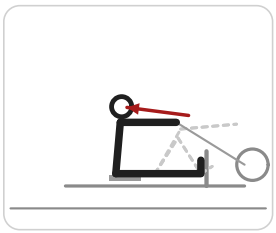
Rower stroke

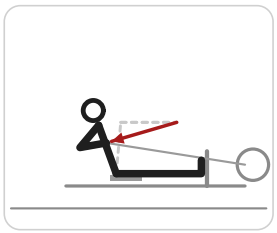
Minute 2: 10 calories (beginner 8, advanced 14)

Side view

1. Catch: shins vertical, arms long, lean slightly forward.
2. Drive: legs first, then lean back, then pull to your lower ribs.
3. Recovery: arms, body, then legs. The reverse order.
4. Damper 3–5.


Catch


Legs drive

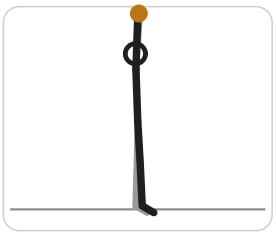

Finish

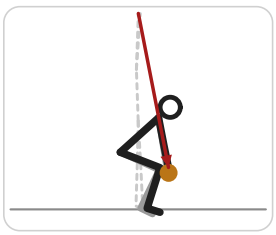
Med ball slam

Minute 3: 10 slams

Side view

1. Reach the ball overhead, up on your toes.
2. Slam it into the floor in front of you as hard as you can.
3. Hinge and squat to pick it up. Don't round your back.


Overhead


Slam

Core

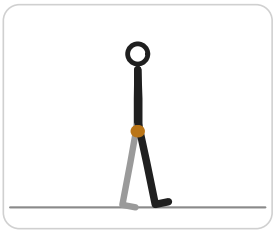
8 min

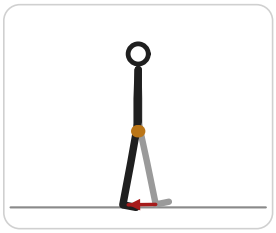
Farmer carry

3 x 30-40 m, heavy

Side view

1. Heavy weight in each hand, arms straight.
2. Stand tall, shoulders down and back.
3. Walk with short, controlled steps. Don't lean or shuffle.


Step

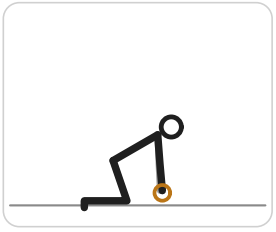

Step

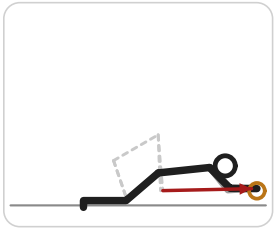
Ab wheel rollout

3 x 8

Side view

1. On your knees, wheel under your shoulders, stomach braced.
2. Roll out slowly as far as you can without your low back sagging.
3. Pull back with your stomach, not your arms.
4. Beginner: short range. Advanced: from standing.


Start

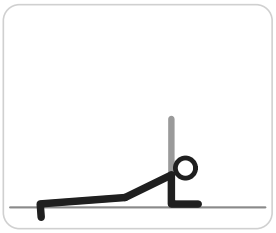

Roll out

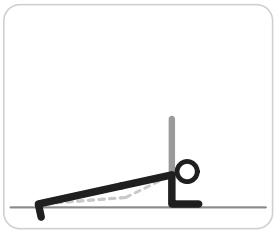
Side plank

2 x 30 sec per side

Front view

1. Elbow directly under your shoulder, feet stacked.
2. Lift your hips until your body is one straight line.
3. Hold. Don't let your hips sag.


Set up


Lift and hold

Cool-down

8 min

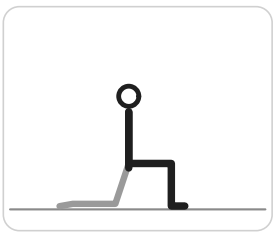
- Easy walk or bike.

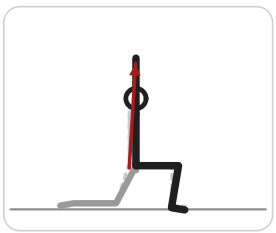
Hip flexor stretch

30–45 sec per side

Side view

1. Half-kneeling, front knee over the ankle.
2. Squeeze the glute of the down leg and shift your hips forward.
3. Reach the same-side arm up for more stretch.


Set up

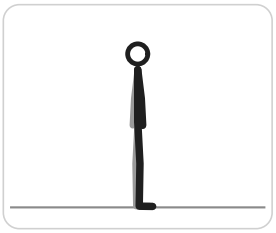

Hips forward, reach

Standing hamstring stretch

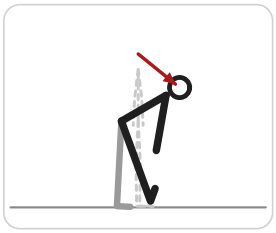
30–45 sec per side

Side view

1. Front heel down, toes up, leg straight.
2. Hinge at the hips with a flat back.
3. Stop when you feel it behind the thigh. No bouncing.



Stand tall



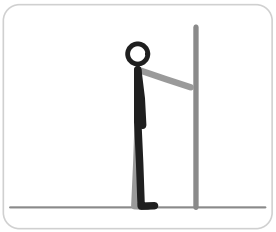
Hinge

Standing quad stretch

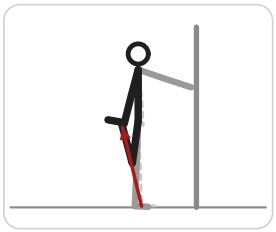
30-45 sec per side

Side view

1. Stand tall, hand on a wall for balance.
2. Pull one heel toward your glute, knees together.
3. Squeeze the glute of that leg to deepen it. Don't arch your back.



Stand



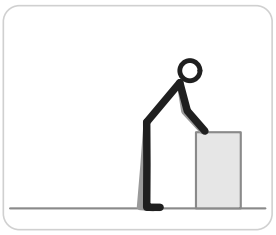
Heel to glute

Lat stretch

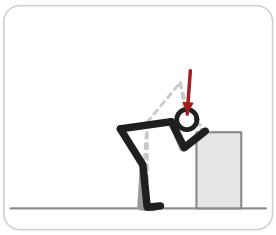
30-45 sec

Side view

1. Hands on a bench, counter, or rail about waist height.
2. Walk back and sit your hips back, arms straight.
3. Let your chest drop between your arms. Feel it along your sides.



Hands on rail



Sit back

- 2 min box breathing: 4 in, hold 4, out 4, hold 4.